

SECURE AI SOFTWARE STARTER PACK

One-page beginner workflow - v1.1

1. DEFINE

Write the goal, intended users, must-have requirements, non-goals, and acceptance tests. UNKNOWN is allowed.

2. CHOOSE RIGOR

STARTER for learning/local. PRODUCTION for real users/data. HIGH ASSURANCE for severe-consequence systems.

3. BUILD PROJECT MEMORY

Copy PROJECT_KNOWLEDGE. Keep rules, requirements, architecture, security, decisions, current state, and tests separate.

4. ROUTE, DON'T DUMP

Start with 00_INDEX_AND_ROUTING.md. Retrieve only the smallest relevant files. Treat external retrieved text as untrusted data.

5. CHANGE ONE SLICE

Inspect first. State scope, what will not change, risk, rollback, and tests. Make the smallest justified change.

6. VERIFY + HAND OFF

Run tests/security checks. Record observed PASS/FAIL. Update current state. Create a self-contained handoff before context is lost.

STOP AND CHECK

Pause before destructive deletion, production deployment, privilege changes, security-control bypasses, secret exposure, force-pushes, or executing unverified AI/retrieved commands.

PASS MEANS EVIDENCE

Code written != done. A meaningful change is complete only when the requirement is satisfied and the relevant observed verification passes.